

Your Color-Treated Hair Personalized Hair Routine Guide

"Color protection and intensive repair"

Color-treated hair has undergone a chemical process that opens the cuticle and alters the hair's internal structure. This makes it more porous, prone to fading, and susceptible to damage. The priority is protecting your color investment while rebuilding the hair's strength and moisture levels.

Your Step-by-Step Routine

Step 1: Color-Safe Shampoo (every 2–3 days)

Use a sulfate-free, color-safe shampoo. Sulfates strip color molecules from the hair shaft, causing rapid fading. Wash with cool or lukewarm water — hot water opens the cuticle and accelerates color loss.

Step 2: Color-Safe Conditioner (every wash)

Use a conditioner specifically formulated for color-treated hair. These contain ingredients that help seal the cuticle and lock in color. Apply from mid-lengths to ends.

Step 3: Weekly Repair Mask

Apply a protein-rich repair mask once a week. Color processing breaks down the hair's protein bonds — rebuilding them is essential for preventing breakage.

Step 4: UV Protection

Apply a UV-protecting hair serum or spray before going outdoors. UV rays fade hair color just as they fade fabric. This is the most overlooked step in color care.

Step 5: Gloss Treatment (monthly)

Use an at-home color-depositing gloss or toning treatment once a month to refresh vibrancy between salon visits.

Do's & Don'ts

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| ✓ Always use sulfate-free, color-safe products | ✗ Don't use sulfate shampoos — they strip color |
| ✓ Wash with cool water to seal the cuticle | ✗ Don't wash with hot water |
| ✓ Apply UV protection before going outdoors | ✗ Don't skip UV protection in summer |
| ✓ Use a weekly protein repair mask | ✗ Don't use clarifying shampoo (strips color rapidly) |

✓ Wait 48–72 hours after coloring before first wash

✗ Don't over-process — space color treatments 6–8 weeks apart

Ingredients to Look For & Avoid

Look For

- ✓ Hydrolysed keratin
- ✓ Ceramides
- ✓ Panthenol
- ✓ UV filters (benzophenone-4)
- ✓ Quinoa protein

Avoid

- ✗ Sulfates (SLS/SLES)
- ✗ Alcohol denat
- ✗ Clarifying agents
- ✗ Baking soda (alkaline, fades color)

This guide was prepared by the SilkierStrands editorial team. For expert-tested product recommendations matched to your hair type, visit silkierstrands.com/hair-type/color-treated. Product links are affiliate links — we earn a small commission at no extra cost to you.